NETHERBLOOM

Book of Remembrance



The Bride Who Stayed Below

The old grave-texts told the dead: do not drink from Lethe; find the spring of Memory. This Book is that spring.

THE SOUL OF THIS BOOK

The Bride Who Stayed Below

Almost saved, once.

They were married at noon in a meadow, under a sky without a single cloud, and he played for the wedding himself. Everyone said they had never heard music like it; the birds stopped to listen and the river went quiet in its bed. That same afternoon, running through the long grass with her shoes in her hand, she stepped on a snake. By evening she was among the dead.

He came after her. No living man had walked down into the dark and come back, but he played at the gates until the guards wept, and the queen of the dead was moved and said yes, on one condition. She could follow him up, all the way, if he did not look back at her before they reached the light. Not once.

So she followed his footsteps up through the dark without a word. He could not hear her; the dead make no sound on the stair. It was a long climb on the narrow stair between the dead and the living. She could see the grey of morning above them, and feel the warmth of his hand where it hung at his side, just ahead of her, almost close enough to touch. One step from the surface he turned to be sure she was there. She saw his face, the instant he turned to look at her: his joy, then his terror. Then the dark took her back.

She has stood in the shadows ever since, at the foot of that stair, deciding whether to remember his face or to let it go. She is not sure which would be kinder. The old ferryman would not take her; she was already halfway home once, he says, and the river does not carry anyone twice.



What the Ferrymen know

She knows the way back down better than anyone. The first time she would Linger in the dark, she is pulled one space back instead, as she was pulled back once before, and she keeps her memory. Turn her Soul card sideways when it has happened.

Twist: Starts with 1 Light. The first time she would Linger in the dark, she is pulled one space back instead of forgetting.

Key Memory: *his face, the instant he turned to look at me*



Keeping the Book

The Book has one page per Reach: page I, *Who I Was* (Reach I); page II, *What I Did* (Reach II); page III, *What I Carry* (Reach III). Each page has four slots, **Place**, **Person**, **Deed** and **Feeling**, which complete a sentence about the soul's life.

Inscribing. When a card Resonates, you may inscribe it if the slot shown on the card is still empty on the page of the Reach the soul is in. A **Key Memory** may be inscribed whenever it is played face up, Resonating or not. To inscribe, put the card in its slot with photo corners instead of discarding it; it stays there for the rest of the game. Oblivion cards and Burned cards cannot be inscribed.

Page rewards. Each page pays a small reward for each pair of neighbouring slots: **Place + Person**, **Person + Deed** and **Deed + Feeling**. When an inscription fills the second slot of a pair, do that pair's reward at once. One card can complete two pairs (a Person inscribed next to a Place and a Deed): do both. Each reward happens once per page; tick its box in the Book. The rewards are printed on each page:

Chapter Blessing. When all 4 slots of a page are filled (3 for the Garland Girl), the page also gives one Chapter Blessing at once (only once per page). The Blessing is not chosen. Check these in order and do the first one that is possible:

If the soul has at least one Fracture: remove 1 Fracture (from the highest well).

Otherwise, if any space has Black Water: remove the Black Water token closest ahead of the soul from the game.

Otherwise, if the forgotten pile has any cards: move the newest forgotten card to the discard pile.

Otherwise nothing happens.

Tuck an inscribed card into the well for its slot: slide its four corners into the photo corners. Slide it out again to reuse the card next game.

I · Who I Was

I was born near...



I loved...



I once...



and ever since I have carried...



☐ PLACE + PERSON
Place 1 Root.

☐ PERSON + DEED
Bloom 1 Root.

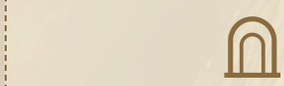
☐ DEED + FEELING
Gain 2 Light.

☐ Chapter Blessing (full page)

Keepsakes ☐ ☐ ☐

II · What I Did

At...



PLACE

...but this, the river has taken

before...



PERSON

...but this, the river has taken

I...



DEED

...but this, the river has taken

The price was...



FEELING

...but this, the river has taken

☐ PLACE + PERSON
Banish the nearest Shade.

☐ PERSON + DEED
Drain the nearest Black Water.

☐ DEED + FEELING
Untie 1 knot on the fullest thread (if tied, you choose).

☐ Chapter Blessing (full page)

Keepsakes ☐ ☐ ☐

III · What I Carry

I go now, leaving...



forgiving...



unable to undo the day I...



holding only...



☐ PLACE + PERSON
Return the newest forgotten card to the discard pile.

☐ PERSON + DEED
Mend 1 Fracture.

☐ DEED + FEELING
The soul steps forward now, if the next space is Lit.

☐ Chapter Blessing (full page)

Keepsakes ☐ ☐ ☐

The Far Shore

At the Far Shore the Keeper lifts the veil and offers the cup. What the soul remembers decides how it drinks.

- ☐ **Inscribed in the Book**: the soul crosses remembering what mattered most.
- ☐ **In the forgotten pile**: the soul crosses without it, lighter and emptier.
- ☐ **Anywhere else** (deck, a hand or the discard pile): it was never spoken, and the soul crosses with it unsaid.

Then read the Book aloud, page by page, even after a loss. Empty slots are read as "...but this, the river has taken".

FERRYMEN _____ LANTERN _____ DATE _____



NETHERBLOOM

RALPH LAUXIE